

Rafael Leroux

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SUMMARY

Infrastructure-focused IT professional with 3+ years of enterprise support experience and a self-built homelab environment that spans Proxmox clustering, OPNsense network segmentation, Active Directory with Linux integration, and Ansible-driven automation. Demonstrated ability to think in systems, document change, and build production-equivalent infrastructure from scratch. Targeting a Systems Administrator or Infrastructure Engineer role.

HOME LAB INFRASTRUCTURE (ACTIVE / ONGOING)

Virtualization, Infrastructure & High Availability

- Deployed and managed a multi-node Proxmox VE cluster with high availability configuration, including node lifecycle management and version upgrades (PVE8 to PVE9) with documented rollback plans
- Deployed Active Directory; automated Linux domain joins via Ansible, including DNS reconfiguration, SSSD, and LDAP integration
- Generating and hardening SSH and SSH keys such as SSH key pass phrases, and configuring public key authentication with no password authentication
- Deployment of Applications via Docker and Docker Compose

Identity & Access Management

- Implemented group-based sudo policy and least-privilege service accounts across domain-joined Linux systems
- Configured Authentik as an OAuth2/OpenID Connect identity provider and LDAP Source Authentication
- Authentik Integration with hosted services, such as Gitea and Semaphore for SSO and LDAP authentication

Networking & Security

- Designed and managed a segmented network in OPNsense: VLAN tagging at Layer 2/3, inter-VLAN routing, firewall rule sets, DHCP scope management, and DMZ architecture
- Configured switch-level VLAN tagging and domain-aware DNS resolution across segments
- Manage SSL termination and reverse proxy via Nginx for self-hosted services
- VPN Deployment using the WireGuard VPN protocol, including a site-to-site VPN
- External DNS Management from CloudFlare with DDNS
- Creating local firewall rules and manage ports on Servers to minimize potential attack surface

Automation & Infrastructure as Code

- Built and operated an Ansible controller managing all homelab hosts: automated patching, configuration management, domain joins, and idempotent playbook design
- Runs Semaphore as an automation UI for orchestrating and auditing Ansible operations
- PowerShell/Bash Scripting for repeated tasks such as user creation and group management (pre-Ansible)

Operational Management

- Applied change management discipline to lab operations: structured change logs, pre/post validation steps, and rollback strategies for every significant change
- Uses Ansible Vault for secrets management; organizes playbooks with structured documentation and version control in self-hosted Gitea
- Git and Gitea for Version control of Ansible code, documentation such as projects with issues and labels
- Python Bot development for Workflow automation such as opening Issues on a Gitea Repository

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

South State Bank | Tier 2 Service Desk Technician | April 2022 – Present

- Provide enterprise-level desktide and remote support across 100+ branch locations; troubleshoot hardware, networking, and bank-specific application issues
- Develop PowerShell scripts to automate resolution of recurring issues, reducing ticket volume and manual workload for the team
- Image, configure, and deploy workstations for new hires and hardware replacements at scale
- Investigate branch-level application latency; coordinate with network and vendor teams to identify and resolve root causes
- Built and maintain a web application with server backend and Microsoft SQL database to monitor Instant Issue Printer and Cashware terminal status organization-wide
- Supported large-scale bank acquisition: onboarded incoming staff, validated acquired company software against SSB hardware, and led Cashware terminal and branch network conversions
- Configuration of Secure Remote Management via PowerShell to non-domain joined devices, including the creation of DNS records for better, cleaner management
- Investigate complex OS and Software related issues and co-ordinate engineering teams and assist with resolutions
- Vulnerability remediation for supported devices such as debit card printers and Cashware Terminals

U.S. Army National Guard | IT Specialist (25U) | July 2016 – July 2022

- Installed, configured, and maintained hardware, software, and communications systems in operational environments
- Completed MOS training at Fort Gordon: LAN design, DHCP server configuration, Domain Controller and Mail Exchange deployment, and Active Directory user administration
- Provided technical support and maintained operational readiness of IT equipment for unit personnel

Apple | At-Home Advisor | Jan 2019 – Jun 2019

- Handled inbound technical support for iOS hardware and Apple ID; escalated complex cases and scheduled repairs

UNCF Silicon Valley | App Development Intern | Jun 2019 – Aug 2019

- Built a Python-based application on a 3-person team; studied data structures to support development

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Virtualization: Proxmox VE (clustering, HA, node management), VMware concepts, Docker

Networking: OPNsense/pfSense, VLANs, firewall rules, DHCP/DNS, DMZ design, Nginx reverse proxy, SSL/TLS, WireGuard/Netbird

Identity & IAM: Active Directory, LDAP, SSSD, OAuth2, OpenID Connect, Authentik, least-privilege, group policy

Automation: Ansible (playbooks, roles, vault, idempotent design), Semaphore, Gitea, Infrastructure as Code concepts

Scripting & Dev: PowerShell, Python, SQL (Microsoft SQL Server, T-SQL), HTML, CSS

OS & Platforms: Windows Server, Linux (Debian/Ubuntu/CentOS/Arch), Windows 10/11, Microsoft 365

Support Tools: SysTrack, ServiceNow-class ticketing, remote support, hardware imaging and deployment

EDUCATION & TRAINING

IT Certificate of Completion | Dixon Hall, Fort Gordon, GA | 2017 – 2019

LAN design, DHCP, Domain Controller, Mail Exchange, Active Directory administration

Computer Science coursework | Florida A&M University | 2018 – 2019